EXPERIMENT – 3

Windows Forensics 1 (TryHackMe)

Aim

To learn Windows registry forensics and to identify important Windows forensic artifacts by completing the TryHackMe room "Windows Forensics 1".

Procedure

- Log in to TryHackMe and open the room "Windows Forensics 1".
- Study "Introduction to Windows Forensics" – why Windows is a rich source of evidence and the type of artifacts that it stores.
- Study "Windows Registry and Forensics" – the registry hives (SAM, SYSTEM, SOFTWARE, SECURITY, NTUSER.DAT and USRCLASS.DAT) and the kind of information each hive holds.
- Study "Accessing Registry Hives Offline" – how the hives can be mounted and read from an acquired image using tools such as Registry Explorer.
- Study the "Data Acquisition" section and learn how the relevant hives are collected from a live or dead system.
- Study "Exploring Windows Registry" and "System Information and System Accounts" – hostname, last shutdown time, user accounts and logon information.
- Study "Usage or Knowledge of Files/Folders" and "Evidence of Execution" – recent files, shellbags, Run keys, prefetch files and jump lists.
- Study "External Devices / USB Device Forensics" – the USB connection artifacts that are stored in the registry.
- Complete the hands-on challenge and read the conclusion of the room.

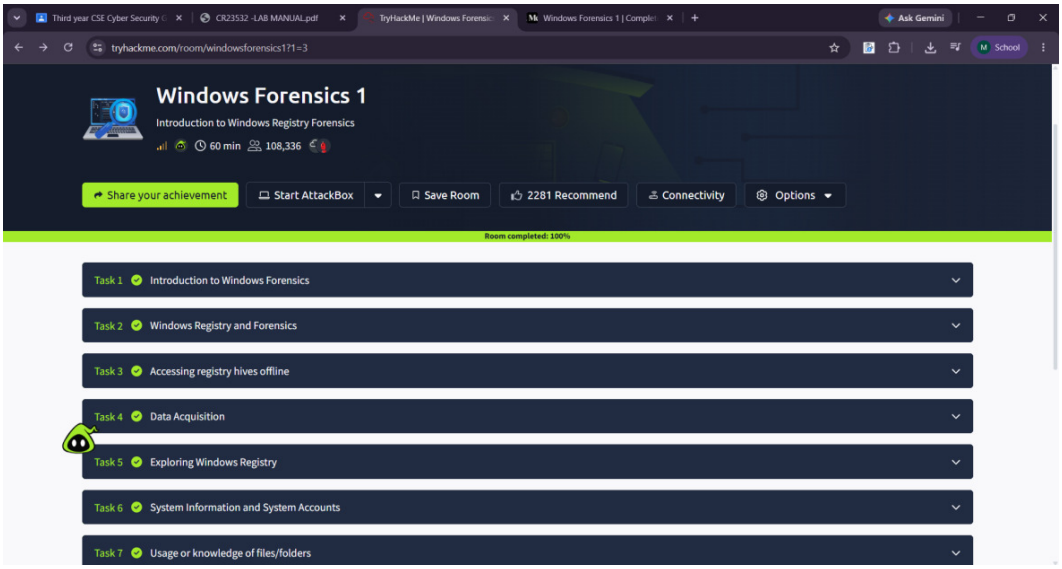


Fig. 3.1 TryHackMe – "Windows Forensics 1" room with the list of tasks
Timestamp: 14-10-2026, 21:06:36

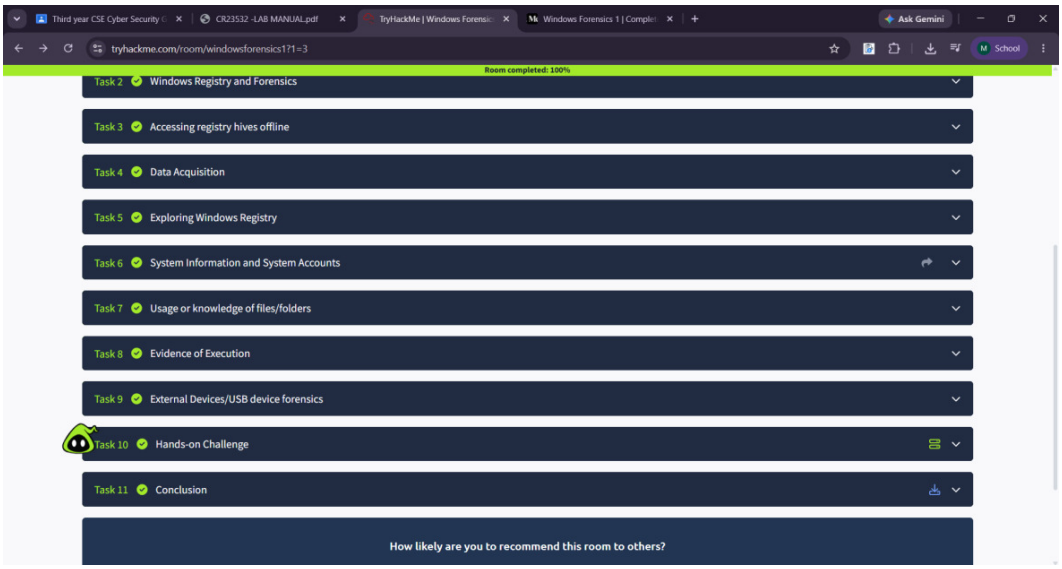


Fig. 3.2 TryHackMe – Windows Registry and Forensics and evidence of execution sections
Timestamp: 14-10-2026, 21:06:50

Result

The "Windows Forensics 1" room was completed successfully. Windows registry hives, evidence of execution, file and folder usage artifacts, and USB device forensics were studied.